Imelda Q. Dimaporo

Imelda "Angging" Quibranza-Dimaporo (born January 15, 1959) is a Filipino politician and public servant from Tubod, Lanao del Norte whose career in government has stretched across nearly three decades and multiple offices.

She is best known as the longtime Governor of Lanao del Norte, a post she held for a combined total of more than eighteen years across two separate terms (1998–2007 and 2016–2025), making her one of the most enduring chief executives in the province's history.

As of 2025, she serves as the Representative for the 1st District of Lanao del Norte in the House of Representatives, continuing a political career that has been closely intertwined with her family's legacy in northern Mindanao.

Popularly called "Angging" by her constituents, she is recognized for blending pragmatic governance with a genuine concern for grassroots welfare, particularly in the areas of health, infrastructure, and community-level public service.

Her flagship initiative, the "Kabarangayan Sigurado" program, brought healthcare and medical services directly to barangays across Lanao del Norte, earning her a reputation as an accessible and people-centered leader.

Together with her husband, Abdullah Dimaporo, and their children, Governor Mohamad Khalid Dimaporo and Congresswoman Sittie Aminah Quibranza Dimaporo, she is part of one of the most politically prominent families in the province's modern history.

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Imelda "Angging" Quibranza-Dimaporo



Born	January 15, 1959 Tubod, Lanao del Norte, Philippines
Nationality	Filipino
Education	Philippine Women's University Bachelor of Science in Business Administration
Spouse	Abdullah Dimaporo
Children	Mohamad Khalid Dimaporo Sittie Aminah Quibranza Dimaporo
Political party	Partido Federal ng Pilipinas (PFP)
Offices held	Governor of Lanao del Norte (1998–2007, 2016–2025) Representative, 1st District, Lanao del Norte (2010–2016, 2025–present)
Nickname	"Angging"

10 Further Reading
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Early Life and Family Background

Imelda Quibranza was born on January 15, 1959, in Tubod, the capital municipality of Lanao del Norte, a province situated along the northwestern shore of Lake Lanao in the Mindanao island group of the Philippines.

She grew up in a family with deep roots in provincial public service.

Her father, former Governor Arsenio Quibranza, was a significant political figure in Lanao del Norte, and his legacy in governance appears to have shaped his daughter's own sense of civic responsibility from an early age.

Growing up in Tubod, the seat of provincial government, Imelda was immersed in the rhythms of local leadership, community affairs, and the day-to-day work of public administration.

This upbringing gave her both an intimate understanding of the province's needs and a personal connection to the communities she would eventually serve.

She later married Abdullah Dimaporo, himself a former Representative, whose family name is likewise deeply embedded in the political landscape of Lanao del Norte and the wider Lanao region.

Their union brought together two prominent political lineages, and together they built a family that has continued to play an active and visible role in provincial governance.

Education

Imelda Quibranza-Dimaporo pursued her higher education at the Philippine Women's University (PWU) in Manila, where she earned a degree in Business Administration.

Founded in 1919, the Philippine Women's University is one of the country's oldest universities and has historically been a center of women's education and leadership development in the Philippines.

Her business administration training gave her a grounding in organizational management, fiscal planning, and administrative systems that would later inform her approach to provincial governance.

While her career has been rooted in public service rather than the private sector, the discipline and analytical skills she developed at PWU appear to have been foundational to her style of governance, particularly her emphasis on program management and coordinated delivery of public services.

Political Career

Early Entry into Public Service

Imelda Quibranza-Dimaporo's entry into formal public office came in 1998, when she was first elected as Governor of Lanao del Norte.

Her ascent to the governorship was not sudden but was shaped by years of engagement in community affairs and her family's long involvement in provincial politics.

Her father's tenure as governor had established the Quibranza name as a symbol of provincial leadership, and Imelda carried that legacy forward while developing her own distinct political identity.

Governor of Lanao del Norte (First Term: 1998–2007)

During her first stint as governor, which spanned nine years and covered the administrations of Presidents Joseph Estrada and Gloria Macapagal Arroyo at the national level, Imelda focused on the twin challenges of infrastructure development and public health access in a province that has historically contended with poverty, conflict spillover from neighboring areas, and uneven delivery of government services.

Her administration worked to expand road networks, improve access to public hospitals and health centers, and channel resources toward the barangay level, where the needs of ordinary constituents are most immediate.

Her approach during this period set the tone for what would become her defining governance philosophy: bringing government closer to the people rather than waiting for communities to come to the capital for services.

Representative, 1st District (2010–2016)

Due to term limits under the Philippine Constitution, Imelda stepped aside from the governorship after 2007.

She subsequently ran for and won a seat in the House of Representatives, representing the 1st District of Lanao del Norte from 2010 to 2016.

Her time in Congress allowed her to pursue legislative advocacy for her province at the national level, including appropriations, peace and development programs for Mindanao, and measures affecting local government units.

During this period, her son Mohamad Khalid Dimaporo served as Governor (2007–2016), continuing the family's presence in provincial executive leadership without interruption.

Governor of Lanao del Norte (Second Term: 2016–2025)

In 2016, Imelda returned to the governorship, winning back the position and beginning what would become an additional nine years at the helm of Lanao del Norte's provincial government.

This second term was marked by continuity in her health-focused governance, a renewed emphasis on infrastructure, and an effort to strengthen peace and order in a region that remained sensitive to security concerns.

Her "Kabarangayan Sigurado" (Secured Barangay) program became the centerpiece initiative of this second gubernatorial stretch, deploying medical missions, health teams, and government services directly to barangays throughout the province.

The program reflected her conviction that governance must be felt at the community level, not just announced from the provincial capitol.

She also remained engaged in peace-building conversations relevant to the broader Bangsamoro region, given Lanao del Norte's proximity to areas directly affected by the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) peace process.

Representative, 1st District (2025–Present)

As her final term as governor concluded in 2025, Imelda successfully ran for the congressional seat vacated by her son Mohamad Khalid Dimaporo, who had himself moved back to the governorship after serving three terms as Representative.

She was elected to represent the 1st District of Lanao del Norte in the 20th Congress, beginning her latest chapter in public service at the age of 66.

Her election to the House in 2025 marked a notable moment in provincial political history: mother and son effectively swapping roles, with Khalid returning to the governorship and Imelda stepping into his congressional seat, while their daughter Sittie Aminah Quibranza Dimaporo was simultaneously re-elected as Representative for the 2nd District.

In the 20th Congress, Imelda was also elected as an officer of the Association of Women Legislators' Foundation Inc. (AWLFI), a recognition of her standing among her female colleagues in the House and her long record of women-centered governance.

Flagship Program: Kabarangayan Sigurado

The "Kabarangayan Sigurado" program is widely considered the defining policy initiative of Imelda Quibranza-Dimaporo's second gubernatorial term.

The program's name, combining the Filipino word *barangay* (the smallest administrative unit in the Philippines) with *sigurado* (certain or secured), captured its core promise: to make basic health and medical services a guaranteed right for every community in the province, regardless of how remote.

Under the program, provincial government teams, including medical personnel, health workers, and social welfare officers, were deployed directly to barangays to conduct medical consultations, distribute medicines, provide maternal and child health services, and connect residents with government assistance programs.

This model of proactive, mobile governance addressed a longstanding gap in health service delivery in rural areas, where poor roads, limited transportation, and inadequate facilities had historically made it difficult for residents to access provincial health infrastructure.

The program also served a peace-building function: by making the provincial government visible and responsive in all barangays, including those in areas with histories of tension or marginalization, it helped build trust between communities and their government.

Family and Political Dynasty

The Quibranza-Dimaporo family represents one of the most prominent political families in the history of Lanao del Norte and is a significant presence in the broader political landscape of northern Mindanao.

Imelda's father, former Governor Arsenio Quibranza, laid the early groundwork of the Quibranza political tradition.

Her husband, Abdullah Dimaporo, served as Representative for the 1st District of Lanao del Norte, adding another branch to the family's governmental reach.

Their son, Mohamad Khalid Dimaporo, has served as both Governor (2007–2016) and Representative (2016–2025) of the 1st District, before returning to the governorship in June 2025, taking his oath of office on June 30, 2025.

Their daughter, Sittie Aminah Quibranza Dimaporo, currently serves as Representative for the 2nd District of Lanao del Norte, having been re-elected to a second term in the 2025 elections.

The result, as of the 20th Congress, is a remarkable configuration: Imelda as 1st District Congresswoman, Sittie Aminah as 2nd District Congresswoman, and Khalid as Governor, all serving simultaneously.

This level of family concentration across the province's top elected posts has drawn both admiration for the family's sustained commitment to public service and scrutiny from critics who see it as an example of political dynasty, a phenomenon that remains constitutionally controversial in the Philippines despite longstanding calls for anti-dynasty legislation.

Civic and Legislative Advocacy

Beyond her executive work as governor, Imelda has been active in women's legislative advocacy, as evidenced by her election as an officer of the Association of Women Legislators' Foundation Inc. (AWLFI) in the 20th Congress.

The AWLFI is a non-partisan organization of women legislators in the Philippines that promotes women's rights, gender-responsive legislation, and the advancement of women in public office.

Her participation in the AWLFI reflects a consistent thread in her public life: the belief that women's voices must be present and influential in the spaces where decisions are made.

Her governance record has also reflected sensitivity to cultural diversity, given that Lanao del Norte is a province with a significant Muslim Filipino (Moro) population, particularly in its municipalities bordering Lanao del Sur and the Lake Lanao basin.

Managing that diversity with equity has been an ongoing dimension of her work as governor and legislator.

Legacy and Significance

Imelda "Angging" Quibranza-Dimaporo's legacy in Lanao del Norte is built on a long and consistent record of public service that has touched three distinct eras of Philippine governance, from the post-People Power Revolution reforms of the late 1990s through the contemporary period of the Bangsamoro peace process and post-pandemic recovery.

Her longevity in office reflects not just political staying power but a genuine connection to her constituents, built through years of hands-on, community-level work.

The "Kabarangayan Sigurado" program, in particular, stands as a tangible expression of her governance philosophy: that public office is not about managing from above but about meeting people where they are.

Her transition from governor to congresswoman in 2025 also signals that she sees legislative work as a natural continuation, rather than a step down, from executive leadership, a perspective that speaks to her ambition to shape policy at the national level after decades of implementing it locally.

As the matriarch of a family that has shaped Lanao del Norte politics across generations, her legacy is also inseparable from the broader story of the Quibranza-Dimaporo dynasty, with all the complexity, continuity, and questions about democratic accountability that such dynasties inevitably carry.

Recognition

- Elected Officer, Association of Women Legislators' Foundation Inc. (AWLFI), 20th Congress (2025)
- Multiple terms as Governor of Lanao del Norte, reflecting sustained electoral trust from the province's constituents

References

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Further Reading

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- Official Gazette of the Republic of the Philippines. Lists of Governors and Representatives, Lanao del Norte.
- House of Representatives of the Philippines. 20th Congress. Member Profile: Imelda Quibranza-Dimaporo.
- Association of Women Legislators' Foundation Inc. (AWLFI). Officers, 20th Congress.

See Also

- Mohamad Khalid Dimaporo
- Sittie Aminah Quibranza Dimaporo
- Abdullah Dimaporo
- Lanao del Norte
- Tubod, Lanao del Norte
- Partido Federal ng Pilipinas
- Association of Women Legislators' Foundation Inc.
- House of Representatives of the Philippines
- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao

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